

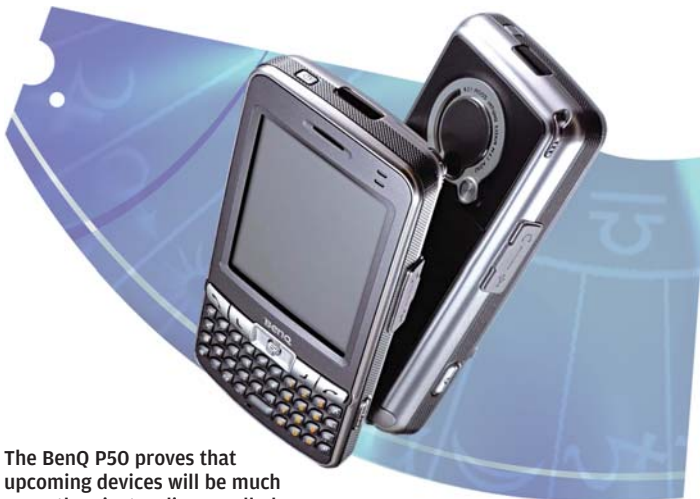
What's New?

We still have the demarcations of products: PDAs are still mainly PDAs, laptops are just being segregated into tablet PCs and laptops, but cell phones, however, are anything but just plain cell phones today. Recently, cell phone manufacturers seem to have caught the innovation bug, and no one is complaining. If anything, we wish the rest of the segments would start innovating just as much.

This doesn't mean that the big names in technology have been sitting idle, churning out boring gadgets. In fact, there are some very exciting products scheduled to hit the markets soon, or at least prototypes of gadgets conjured up by creative minds. Let's take a look at some cool gadgets that we think have the potential to make it big.

BenQ's P50

This PDA phone is 120 x 60 x 20 mm large and weighs a mere 170 grams. It sports a 240 x 320 pixel touchscreen that displays 256K colours. The OS is Microsoft Windows PocketPC 2003. From the cell phone angle, it is quad-band (GSM



The BenQ P50 proves that upcoming devices will be much more than just ordinary cell phones

850/900/1800/1900), has 64-channel polyphonic ringtones, supports GPRS class 10, MMS, infrared, Bluetooth, WAP 2.0, and a Li-Ion battery with a standby time of 100 hours.

In terms of PDA functionality, it has handwriting recognition, inbuilt 64 MB memory, SD/MMC slots, JAVA for downloadable games, a USB port, 1.3 megapixel camera with a top resolution of 1280 x 960 pixels, video capture, photo album, MP3/MPEG-4 player, Wi-Fi, and not to forget, the QWERTY keyboard.

If recent trends are anything to go by, this device will fit right in when it is finally released. As you can see, cell phones are becoming much more powerful than ever before.

Samsung's SCH-V770

It's a phone with a camera! No, it's a camera with a phone... the argument continues, especially here at *Digit*. Whatever it is, it's both, a cellular phone as well as a camera—and a good one at that!



Samsung's SCH-V770 will hardly be noticed as a phone, but does prove that high-end cameras and mobile phones can be integrated as a single product

The phone boasts of a 7-megapixel camera with 3x optical zoom and 5x digital zoom and autofocus, and yes (finally!), a flash as well. In fact, it's the inclusion of the flash that's got people at *Digit* arguing over whether it's a camera-phone or a phone-camera.

The camera supports the attachment of teleconversion and wide-angle lenses—a first on a phone, for sure. It offers a host of other camera features, including manual control of focus and focal length, shutter speeds, control over exposure times and auto exposure locking, and advanced features such as aperture priority and shutter priority.

It also records video at QVGA resolution (16 million colours) at 15 to 30 frames per second, and has a TV-Out connector so you can view both, stills and movies with the family.

From the phone point of view, it's pretty standard—CDMA, 64-channel polyphonic ringtones, and so on. It also throws in an MP3 player and a card reader!

Somehow, one gets the feeling Samsung is just showing off their technical prowess by making this gadget—not that anyone's complaining, right?



Nokia's Internet Tablet PC is a step in the right direction, proving that the majority of functions we do on the Internet don't need a PC, or even a keyboard!